

30, could not be misunderstood.¹⁵ And with chap. 8 removed, the incongruity of chaps. 9 and 10 with their surroundings would be very much more obvious. Imagine 9:1 following directly upon 7:72!

2. *The evidence from Josephus.*—Josephus, who is the earliest writer (of those known to us) to excerpt the Chronicler's history, used Edition B. As his method is to give only such extracts as suit his purpose, and he frequently vaults over whole chapters and gives to others only a sentence or a clause, it is not always easy to follow him. The two chapters, Neh. 9 and 10, obviously contain hardly anything that he could use for his history; and, in fact, he makes no use of them at all, unless we find them alluded to in certain phrases at the end of his abridgment of Neh. 8. In telling the story of Ezra, when he comes to the account of the reading of the law he gives in concise form the contents of Neh. 8, to the very end of the chapter (*Antt.*, xi, 154–57). In finishing the account, he says that Ezra urged the people not to mourn, saying that it would be better for them at that time to keep the feast with joy, καὶ τὴν μετάνοιαν καὶ λύπην τὴν ἐπὶ τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν ἐξημαρτημένοις ἀσφάλειάν τε ἔξιν καὶ φυλακὴν τοῦ μηδὲν ὅμοιον συμπεσεῖν. And he then adds, that after the people had kept the feast for the eight days, ἀνεχώρησαν εἰς τὰ οἰκεία μετὰ ὕμνων τοῦ θεοῦ (cf. Neh. 9:5?) τῆς ἐπανορθώσεως τῶν περὶ τὸ πολίτευμα παρανομηθέντων "Εξδρα χάριν εἰδότες. Either one or both of these passages may well have been suggested by Neh. 9 and 10; but more than this can hardly be said. Josephus then passes on to the story of Nehemiah, which he gives in greatly abridged form. After narrating how the building of the wall was finished, he proceeds (xi, 180 f.): τὰ μὲν οὖν ἔθνη τὰ ἐν τῇ Συρίᾳ . . . ἐδυσφόρει (= Neh. 6:16—end). Νεεμίας δὲ τὴν πόλιν ὁρῶν ὀλιγανθρωπουμένην (= Neh. 7:4, καὶ ὁ λαὸς ὀλίγος ἐν αὐτῇ) τοὺς ἱερεῖς τε καὶ Λευῖτας παρεκάλεσεν τὴν χώραν ἐκλιπόντας μετελθεῖν εἰς τὴν πόλιν καὶ μένειν ἐν αὐτῇ. (Neh. 11:1, 10–23; 12:1–26) τὸν τε γεωργοῦντα λαὸν τὰς δεκάτας τῶν καρπῶν ἐκέλευσε φέρειν εἰς Ἱεροσόλυμα, ἵνα τρέφεσθαι διηνεκῶς ἔχοντες οἱ ἱερεῖς καὶ Λευῖται μὴ καταλείπωσι τὴν θρησκείαν (Neh. 12:44; 13:10–12).

It can hardly be doubted, in view of all this—and with nothing to point to the contrary conclusion—that the two chapters, Neh. 9 and 10, stood at the end of the book of Ezra in the B edition.

¹⁵ To say nothing of the καὶ εἶπεν "Εξδρας with which 9:6 begins in the Greek version!